

Linear models

Jeff Leek

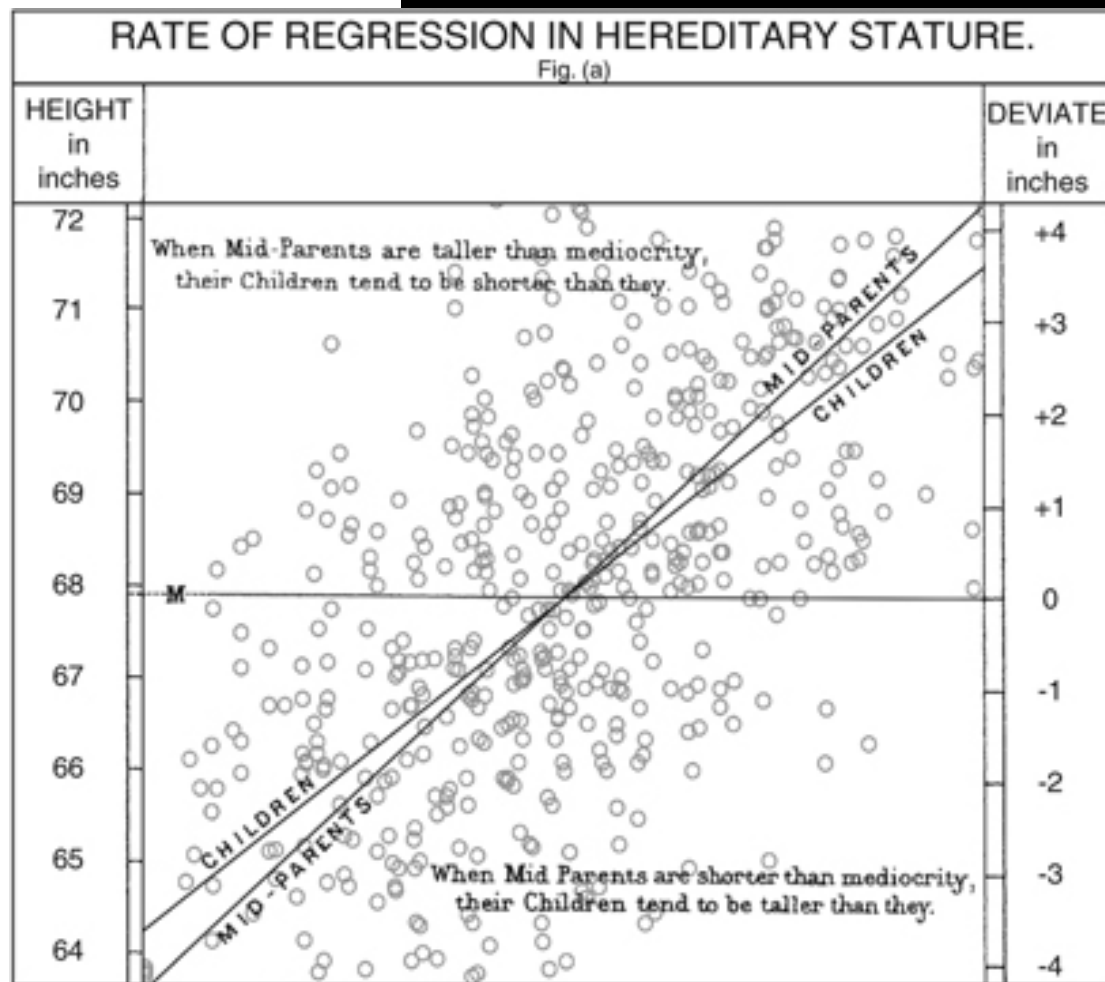
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Basic idea

- Fit the “best line” relating two variables
- In math we are minimizing the relationship $(Y - b_0 - b_1X)^2$
- You can always fit a line, the question is whether it is a good fit or not

An old, but really useful idea!



**Still relevant everywhere in
genomics**

Article

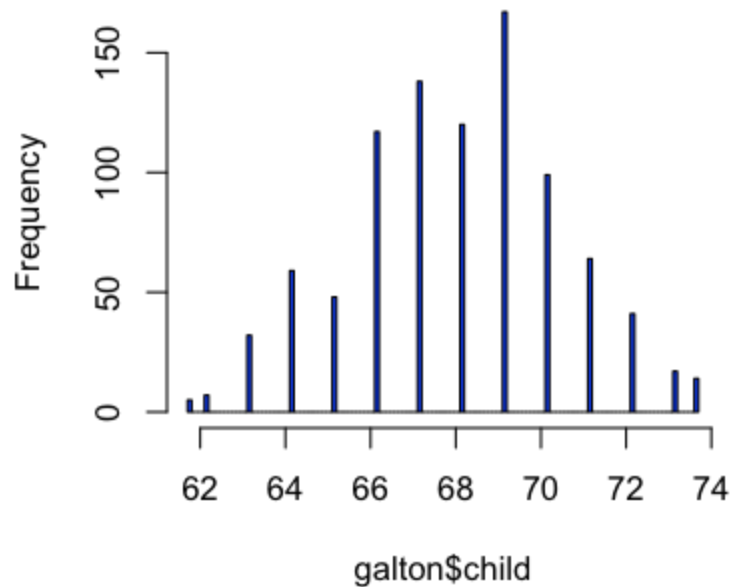
European Journal of Human Genetics (2009) **17**, 1070–1075; doi:10.1038/ejhg.2009.5; published online 18 February 2009

Predicting human height by Victorian and genomic methods

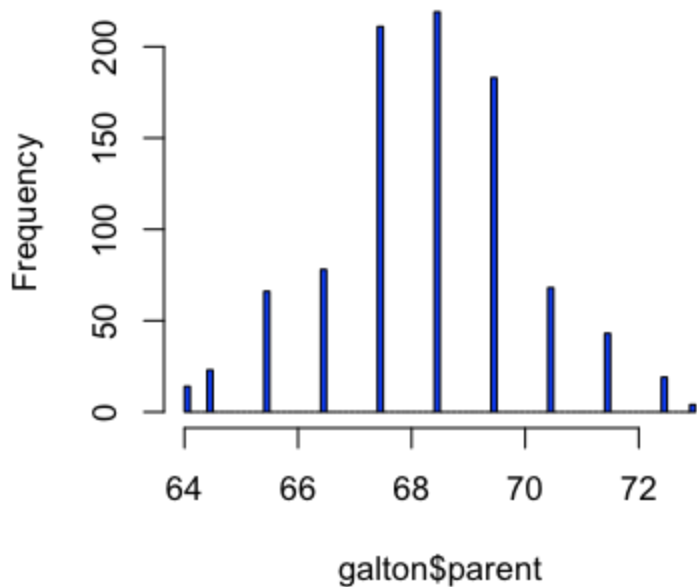
Yurii S Aulchenko^{1,2,7}, Maksim V Struchalin^{1,3,7}, Nadezhda M Belonogova^{2,4}, Tatiana I Axenovich², Michael N Weedon⁵, Albert Hofman¹, Andre G Uitterlinden⁶, Manfred Kayser³, Ben A Oostra¹, Cornelia M van Duijn¹, A Cecile J W Janssens¹ and Pavel M Borodin^{2,4}

The Galton example explained

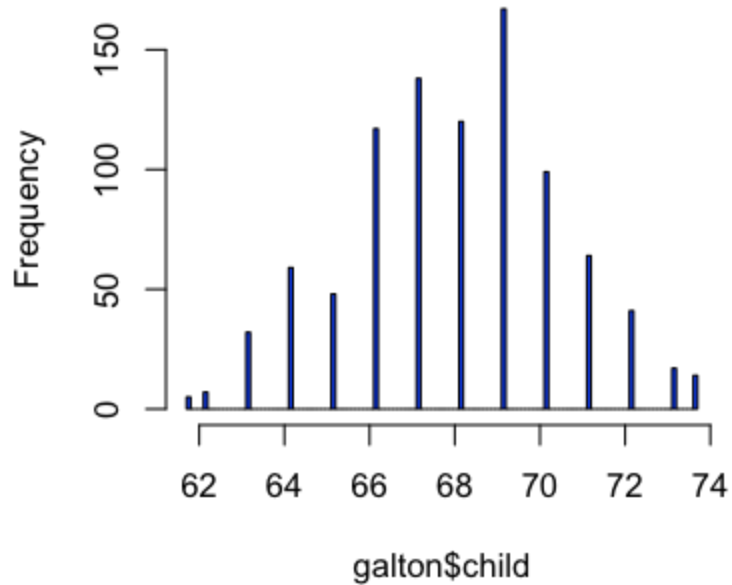
Histogram of galton\$child

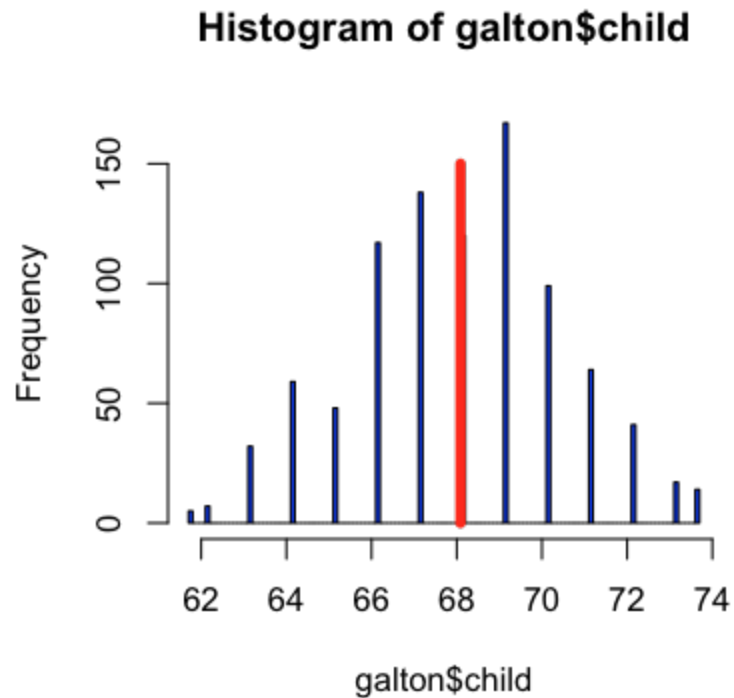


Histogram of galton\$parent

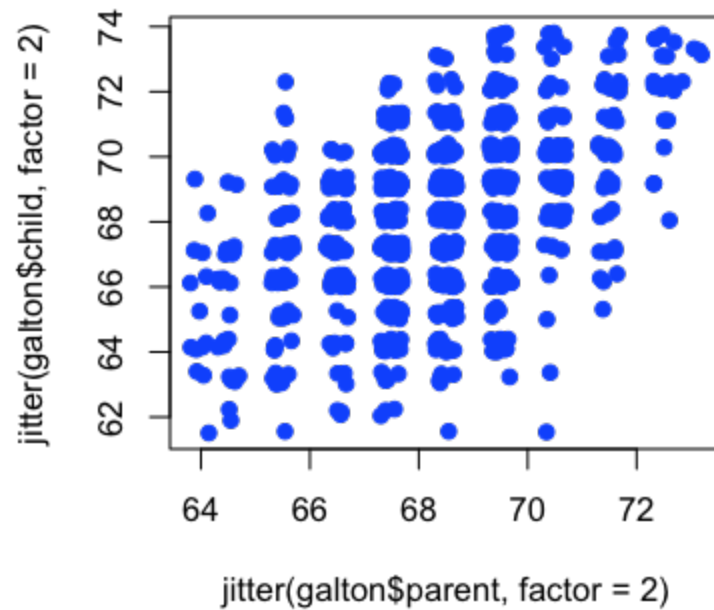


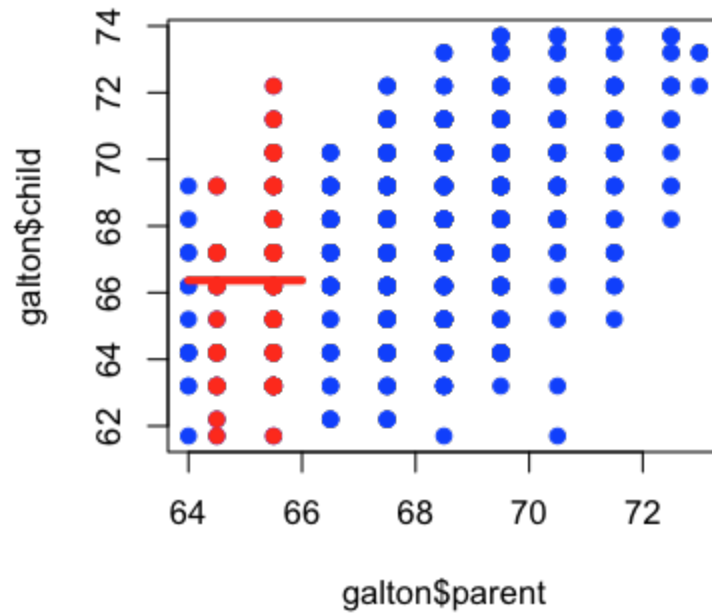
Histogram of galton\$child

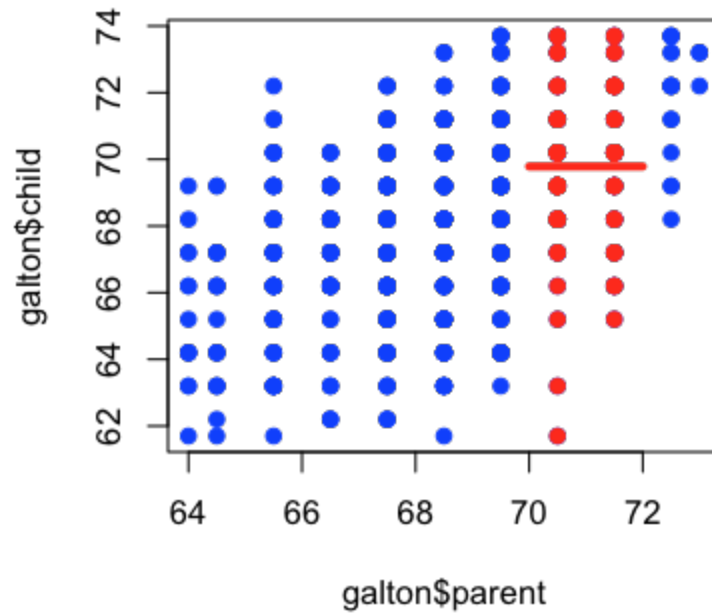


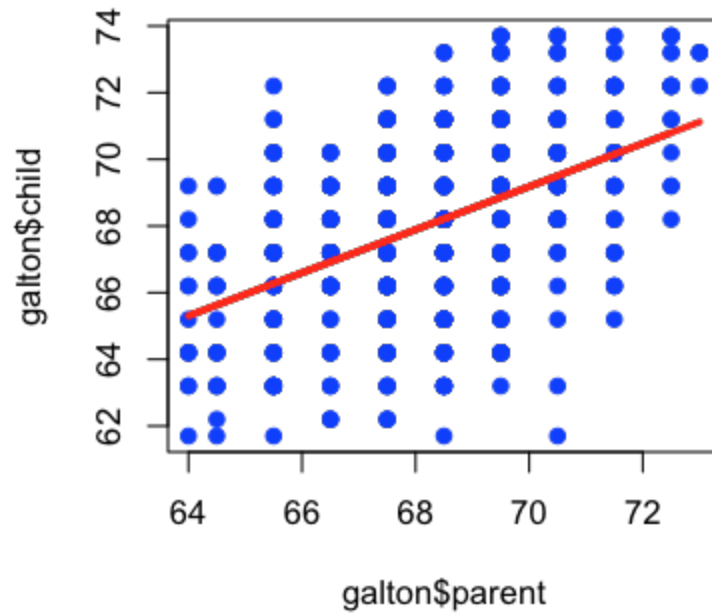


Minimizes $\sum(Y - c)^2$



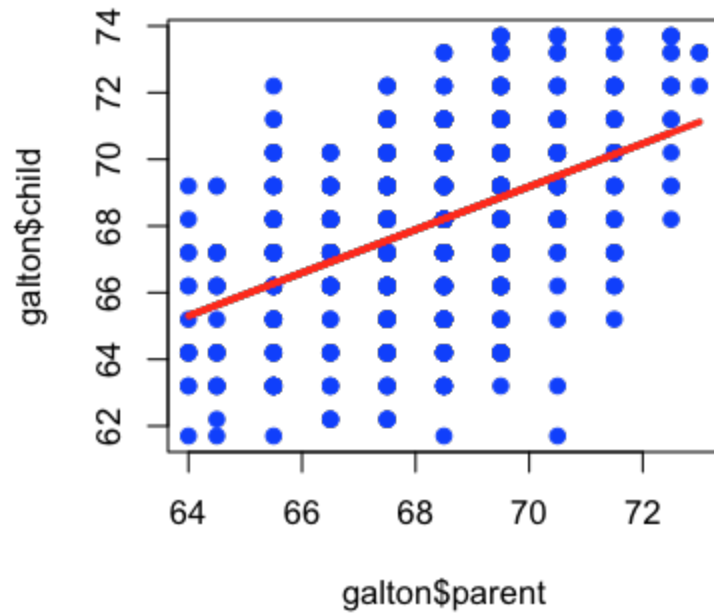






Equation for a line:

$$C = b_0 + b_1 P$$



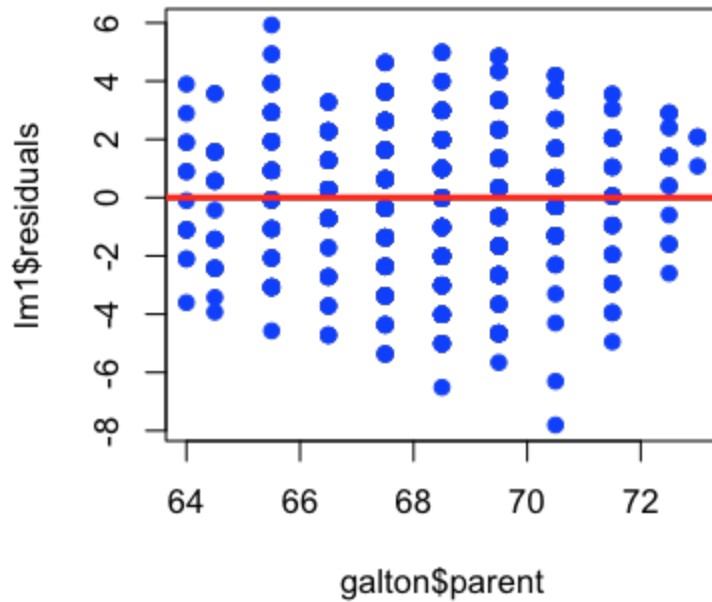
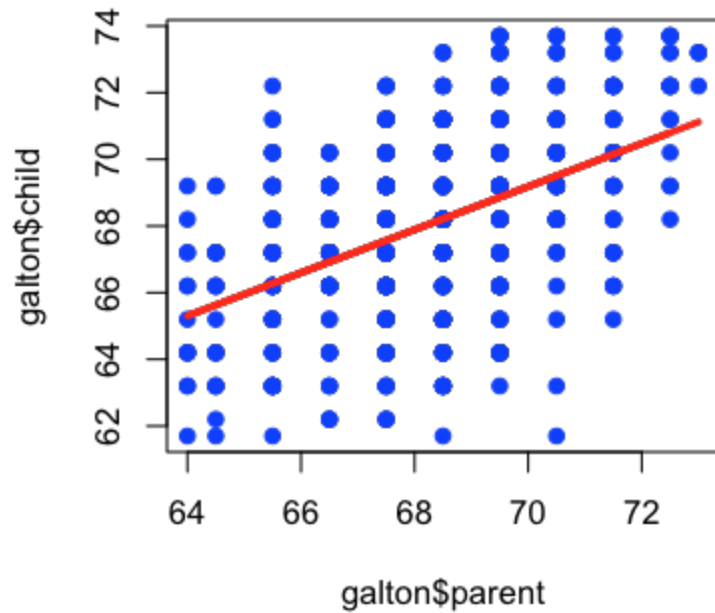
Equation with noise

$$C = b_0 + b_1 P + e$$

Fit by minimizing

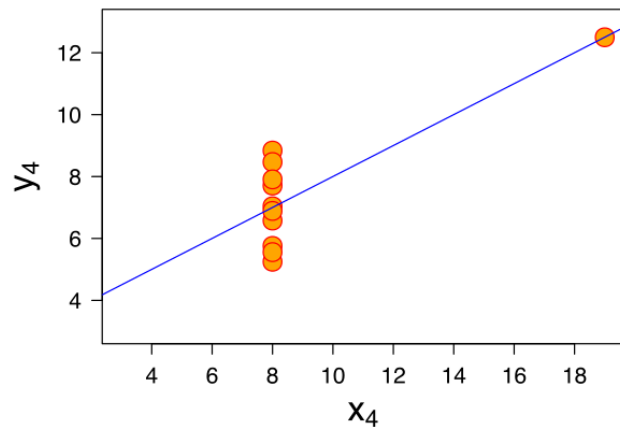
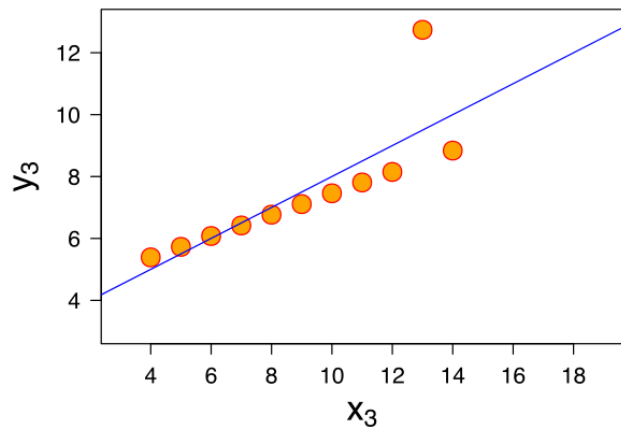
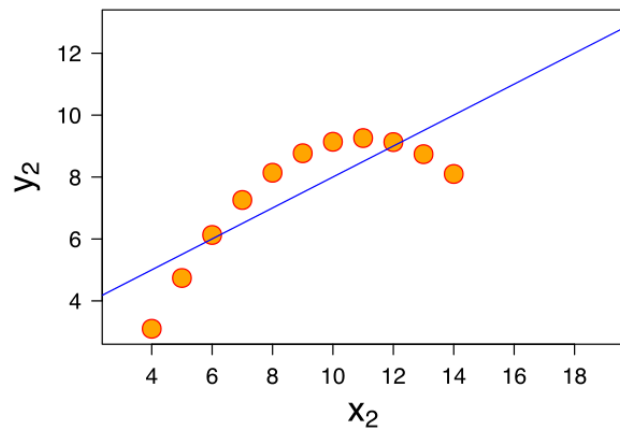
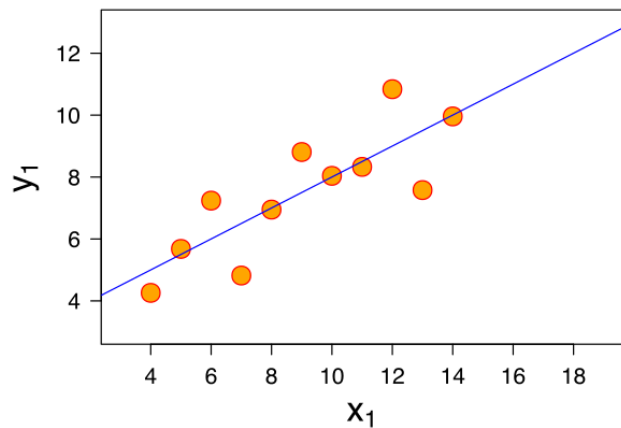
$$\sum (C - b_0 - b_1 P)^2$$

Check residuals



You can always fit a line

But it might not be the right thing



Notes and further reading

- Linear models is a whole class (no joke): <https://www.coursera.org/course/regmods>
- Basic thing to keep in mind is does the line fit?
- Great additional notes in Chapter 2 here: <http://genomicsclass.github.io/book/>